Elliott Owens

People & HR Operations Leader | Human Resources | Employee Experience & Workforce Planning

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SUMMARY

People Operations leader with experience building scalable people processes, improving employee retention, and aligning workforce strategy with business performance. Managed end-to-end people operations for a 40+ person workforce within a $15M business unit, achieving sub-6% employee turnover, cut new-hire ramp time from 90 to 30 days, and reduced time-to-fill from 30+ days to under 2 weeks. Experienced in talent acquisition, employee life cycle management, workforce planning, HRIS management and compliance, performance management, and people analytics. Combines operational leadership with a data-driven, employee-centered approach to building effective teams and sustainable business practices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sephora *Seattle, WA*

Assistant Store Manager [People Operations / HR Generalist Functions] | *Mar 2021 – Jan 2026*

- **Sub-6% turnover across a 40+ person FT/PT team (typically 3-4x higher in retail):** designed and ran onboarding, L&D, and performance-review programs end to end, built around peer-shadow training and 30-60-90-day check-ins.
- **Cut ramp-to-productivity from 90 to 30 days:** rebuilt onboarding from a self-paced module list into a structured program with Day-1 orientation, daily peer shadowing, and manager readiness checks, reaching 100% module compliance and 80%+ new-hire satisfaction.
- **Reduced time-to-fill from 30+ days to under 2 weeks:** owned full-cycle recruiting with Eightfold AI and SuccessFactors, cutting resume screening by 10+ hours per week.
- **Primary HR point of contact for corporate HR and regional leadership:** coordinated policy rollout and compliance updates, and coached managers through employee relations issues and performance conversations.
- Led the people side of a full remodel and technology transition across operations, IT, and corporate HR, **sustaining 80%+ employee satisfaction** throughout.
- **Built a repeatable internal promotion pipeline** by identifying and developing high-potential talent, reducing external hiring need at the leadership level.
- **Drove workforce planning with Tableau analytics (payroll, labor budgeting, Dayforce scheduling),** sustaining a 24% margin while supporting 6% YoY growth on $15M in sales.

Nordstrom *Seattle, WA*

Cosmetics Business Manager | *Oct 2016 – Feb 2021*

- **60% increase in average client transaction value**: built through service-excellence strategies and cross-functional partnership across the sales floor, turning one-time purchases into repeat relationships.
- **$700K+ in combined annual revenue** ($200K for a small cosmetic line, $500K+ for a mid-size line): driven by creative event programming, targeted selling strategies, and an elevated client experience from first visit to repeat customer.
- **Sales unit adoption of a new digital tool**: led the rollout through one-on-one coaching and change management, turning a top-down mandate into a habit the team kept using.
- **Managed client data** in a CRM platform, maintaining accuracy and privacy standards that supported personalized outreach without cutting corners.

Independent Contracting Services *Remote*
Freelance Brand & Communications Consultant — Remote Program Management | *2013 – Present*

- Independently managed 12+ years of concurrent client engagements fully remotely, owning timelines, budgets, and stakeholder communication end-to-end from brief to delivery — the same autonomy, organization, and asynchronous coordination required for distributed HR program management.
- Delivered brand identity, visual communication, and marketing programs for clients across multiple time zones, building durable habits for async communication, self-directed prioritization, and remote stakeholder management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

People Operations & HR Strategy:
· Employee Relations & Engagement
· Workforce Planning & Headcount Strategy
· Succession Planning
· Change Management & Policy Compliance
· Coaching & Offboarding

Talent & Employee Lifecycle:
· Talent Acquisition & Onboarding
· Performance Management & Coaching
· Learning & Development Program Design
· Benefits Guidance and support
· I-9 & E-Verify (Equifax)

Systems & Analytics:
· HR & People Analytics (Tableau)
· Payroll & Workforce Scheduling (Dayforce)
· CRM Platforms
· Microsoft Office Suite
· HRIS (SuccessFactors, Eightfold, & Workday)

Distributed Collaboration:
· Remote & Cross-Site Stakeholder Management
· Asynchronous Program Delivery
· Cross-Time-Zone Coordination

EDUCATION

Seattle Pacific University *Seattle, WA*
Bachelor of Arts — Visual Communication Design
Minor: New Media & Social Media Marketing

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Native) | Spanish (B2.1 — conversational, actively developing)
Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript | Tableau | CRM Platforms | macOS, Windows, iOS, Android | Microsoft Office (Expert) | Google Suite (Intermediate)
Time Zone Flexibility: Global
Work Authorization: US citizen; available immediately for fully remote roles.